Zach Zukowski

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STABLECOIN, TOKENIZATION & PAYMENTS STRATEGY

SUMMARY

Stablecoin and tokenization strategist with experience advising 100+ tokenization engagements across stablecoin issuers, tokenized real-world assets, and lending platforms. Founding research hire at Borderless Capital (a registered investment adviser), where I built the research function from scratch and supported underwriting across ~250 investments and ~$500M in assets under management. Specializes in reserve custody, redemption architecture, settlement design, and portability risk across providers and networks. Seven-paper research program (four on SSRN), with work submitted to the Federal Reserve's Fifth Conference on the Dollar's International Roles (June 2026).

EXPERIENCE

Senior Investment Analyst, Digital Assets | Borderless Capital (RIA; first hire) *Dec 2019 – Present*

- Advised on 100+ tokenization engagements across stablecoin issuers, tokenized real-world assets, and lending platforms: reserve architecture, incentive design, launch-readiness standards, and regulatory surface mapping.
- Led diligence on stablecoin and tokenization settlement infrastructure: reserve custody and composition, redemption pathways and service-level agreements, settlement finality, concentration and portability risk, and stress-episode behavior across issuers, custodians, and settlement banks.
- Translated regulatory change (GENIUS Act, CLARITY Act, state licensing frameworks) into concrete product, reserve, routing, and compliance decisions. Research on how payment stablecoins, tokenized deposits, and yield-bearing wrappers (tokenized money-market funds, T-bill strategies) each inherit distinct regulatory perimeters informs product design, compliance architecture, and go-to-market strategy.
- Developed the **CLII** classifying regulatory intensity (custody segregation, reconciliation integrity, and concentration risk), and the **MVEP** framework defining nine categories of institutional tokenization diligence. Both published on SSRN.
- Built automated monitoring for tokenization products from SEC filings and press releases; analyzed ~75 tokenization offerings in 2025 and invested in 18. Built AI-assisted diligence workflows reducing subscription-document review time from ~4 hours to ~1 hour per deal.
- Built quantitative token-economic models forecasting emissions, fee capture, subsidy-to-revenue trajectories, and governance concentration under wide scenario ranges. Modeled token supply equilibrium (burn-mint dynamics), adaptive feedback emission controllers, and penalty-driven token destruction (slashing) to guide mechanism design and advisory with leading Layer 1 teams.
- Built the firm's research function from scratch and led a four-analyst team producing ~25 long-form publications annually. Supported underwriting across ~250 investments (~$500M AUM, ~10 funds). Led 9 accelerator programs (~75 teams taught); served on a Uniswap Foundation governance committee (2024); ETHDenver pitch judge.

Analyst Intern | Greenway Solutions (USAA) *May – Sep 2016*

- Benchmarked USAA fraud controls across online, mobile, and call-center channels versus 9 peer U.S. banks; delivered recommendations on funds-availability, wire-transfer, and identity-verification controls.

SELECTED RESEARCH

- **Routing the Dollar.** *Submitted, Fed Reserve Board / FRBNY, June 2026. SSRN.* How gateway infrastructure concentrates control, routes settlement, and determines operator accountability under stress.
- **Dollar v3 / The Control Layer War.** *Published.* How CLARITY and GENIUS provisions concentrate value and liability at the control layer operators build.
- **Minimum Viable Equivalence Packs.** *SSRN.* The institutional diligence standard operators must clear before tokenized products reach committee.
- **Adaptive Tokenomics.** *SSRN.* Systems-engineering design laboratory stress-tested with 240-run Monte Carlo ensemble across four adversarial scenarios. Adaptive emissions as tail-risk insurance; slashing dominates supply during bootstrapping.

TECHNICAL

Methods: Agent-based Monte Carlo simulation, adaptive feedback control systems, token supply equilibrium modeling, concentration and scenario analysis
Data: Dune Analytics, Nansen Pro, Artemis, DefiLlama, CoinGecko, Helius, Spacescope, SEC filing monitoring
Languages: Python (pandas, statsmodels, scipy, matplotlib), SQL (DuneSQL, Trino), JavaScript/TypeScript, Excel
Infrastructure: 10 custom Python MCP servers for real-time data feeds, Claude Code, Cursor, n8n, Apify, Git/GitHub

EDUCATION

High Point University | B.S.B.A., Business Administration (Magna Cum Laude) *2018*
Investment Club President | Lingnan University, Hong Kong (Exchange)